STUDIO VALENTINA

AI FOR ARCHITECTS

Free Guide · The Workflow Playbook

Where artificial intelligence actually helps in a real project — and where it must never touch.
Edition 2026



From the Built Intelligence newsletter · studio-valentina.com

01 THE MAP

AI is not one tool.
It is five different jobs.

Most architects try to use AI everywhere and end up trusting it nowhere. Decide, per phase, what you are delegating: speed, volume of options, or writing — never judgment.

01

Brief & research

Summarize zoning text, client interviews and precedent studies. Turn a two-hour call into a structured program.

SAVES 2–4 H / PROJECT

02

Concept & options

Generate massing variations, facade studies and mood direction fast, then draw the one that actually works.

VOLUME, NOT ANSWERS

03

Documentation

Draft specs, schedules, sheet notes, RFIs and submittal responses from your own standards.

ALWAYS VERIFIED

04

Visualization

Post-process renders, fill context, clean up people and vegetation, test material and lighting direction before you commit GPU hours.

05

Client communication

Translate technical decisions into plain language, in English or Spanish. Proposals, change-order explanations, weekly updates.

02 THE STACK

Four tools, not forty.

A Language & reasoning

- **ChatGPT / Claude** — briefs, specs, emails, code and zoning summaries. Feed it your own standards, not a blank page.
- **Copilot in Microsoft 365** — meeting notes to action items, proposal drafts inside Word.
- **Notebook-style tools** — upload the permit set and the code, then ask questions against those documents only.

B Image & render

- **Midjourney** — mood, material and atmosphere direction in the concept phase.
- **Veras / Enscape AI** — renders generated from your real Revit or SketchUp geometry, so the proportions stay yours.
- **Magnific / upscalers** — resolution and detail for presentation boards.

Rule of thumb: if the geometry matters, the AI must start from *your model*. If only the feeling matters, a text prompt is enough.

03 THE WORKFLOW

A five-step loop you can run this week.

01
Give context
Project type, climate, code, budget, client words. No context, no useful output.

02
Ask for options
Request 3–5 alternatives with trade-offs, never a single "best" answer.

03
Draw it yourself
Take the direction into Revit or Rhino. The model stays the source of truth.

04
Verify
Check every number, code reference and dimension against the real source.

05
Save the prompt
A prompt that worked is an office standard. Keep a library.

TASK	MANUAL	WITH AI	WHAT YOU STILL DO
Zoning summary	2–3 h	20 min	Confirm with the planning office
Spec section draft	3 h	45 min	Product data and liability review
Client update email	30 min	5 min	Tone, promises, dates
Concept mood board	4 h	1 h	Curation — the taste is yours

04 NON-NEGOTIABLES

What AI must never do.

01 Professional limits

- [ ] It does not stamp, seal or sign anything — a licensed professional does
- [ ] It does not decide structure, egress or life safety
- [ ] It does not replace a code review with the authority having jurisdiction
- [ ] Every code citation it gives is treated as a hypothesis until verified

02 Data & ethics

- [ ] No client names, addresses, drawings or contracts in public tools
- [ ] Disclose AI-assisted imagery when it could read as a real photo
- [ ] Never present a generated image as a buildable design
- [ ] Check your contract and your client's NDA before uploading anything

The signature on the drawing is still yours. AI changes how fast you get to the decision — not who is responsible for it.

NEXT STEPS

Keep going.

01

Built Intelligence

The newsletter on LinkedIn: AI, BIM and architecture, every edition.

02

Prompt Pack

30 prompts written for architecture, ready to copy. Free at studio-valentina.com/resources.

03

Work together

Architecture and interior design for custom homes in Georgia.



studio-valentina.com · WhatsApp +1 (678) 490-5574 · officestudiovalentina@gmail.com

General information only, not legal or professional advice. Tool names belong to their owners and are referenced for identification only. Verify every technical output against the original source and your jurisdiction.